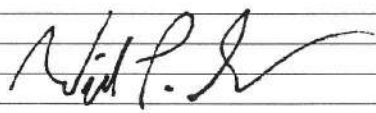


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2003-120

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form		
CBRC FILE #: 2003-120		A
RESULTS:		
Species: (Common Name) Eastern Wood-Pewee		(Scientific Name) Contopus virens
Date(s) of occurrence: 30 Aug 03		
Number of birds seen: 1	Sex: (Singing bird)	Plumage: Adult
Exact location: Holmes Grove, Chico Basin Ranch (Near Banding Station)		
County: El Paso	Nearest town: Hanover	Elevation: ~5100'
Length of observation: 5+ minutes of singing, longer visual		Time(s) of observation: About 5:30 pm
Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Chris Wood, Nancy Gobris		
Other observers who independently saw the bird(s):		
Light conditions (quality; direction relative to bird(s) and observers position: Fair light (overcast, but even light), but bird often backlit against sky.		
Optical equipment used: Minox 8.5 X 42		
Distance to bird(s) (estimated, unless otherwise noted): We got almost directly underneath the bird, which was about 12-15 meters up in a tree top.		
Was (Were) bird(s) photographed? No		If so, are you submitting photos?
Who took the photograph(s)?		
Describe the general and specific habitats in which the bird(s) occurred: Large deciduous tree grove, surrounded by horizon-to-horizon short grass prairie & semi desert shrubland. (Great migrant trap.)		
Describe the bird's (birds') behaviors, particularly behaviors that were used in supporting the identification, e.g., flying, feeding, habits: The most important thing is that the bird was singing for about 5 minutes. Otherwise it was observed perching high in the trees, occasionally moving to a different tree.		
DESCRIPTION – I didn't see the bird well (too high in tree, too backlit, etc.) but it clearly was some kind of medium/small flycatcher. The bird's size and structure ruled out larger types such as Myiarchus or Tyrannus flycatchers. The white wing bars, size, and "vested" appearance suggested an Empidonax or Contopus flycatcher. It looked a bit bigger and less "compact" than the many Empidonax species that we had been seeing, that day and it had a different perching habit, preferring the tree top. The main and most obvious ID point was the song (described below.)		
Describe the bird's (birds') call(s) and/or song(s), if noted: This identification was based mainly on the song heard. For about 5 minutes the bird continuously gave a classic Eastern Wood-Pewee song. Each phrase consisted of the three-syllable "pee-a-weeeee." The bird paused for several seconds between each phrase. In each phrase, the first two syllables were short and crisp, and the last syllable was drawn out, usually rising slightly. The song was high and a bit thin, and had a whistled quality.		
SIMILAR SPECIES – Empidonax flycatchers look superficially similar, but none have vocalizations approaching the distinctive Eastern Wood-Pewee song. Western Wood-Pewee looks very similar, but has a song with much different qualities. Western Wood-Pewees usually gives one or two syllable songs that are lower in pitch and much rougher sounding than Eastern Wood-Pewee songs. To me the two-syllable version of Western Wood-Pewee sounds kind of crickety, and the one-syllable version (which I think they give more commonly) is kind of a harsh quick buzz.		
What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I hear Eastern Wood-Pewee songs yearly in Minnesota and Wisconsin when I visit in the early summer. I hear Western Wood-Pewee songs frequently throughout late spring and summer around Colorado in appropriate habitats.		
List books, guides, recordings, or other sources consulted and how these influenced your identification (during and after observation): Sibley Guide to Birds, Stokes Field Guide to Bird Songs (Eastern and Western Regions), and Bird Songs of the Rocky Mountain States and Provinces.		
This report was made from: Notes made after observation.		
Date and time of written report: 20 Jan 03		
Reporting observer: William P Schmoker		Signature: 
Reporting observer's address: 3381 Larkspur Dr. Longmont, CO 80503 email: bill@schmoker.org		